

call with iOS and OSX catering to all iPhone, iPad, iMac and MacBook users. Similarly, Google has delivered an extremely popular and versatile smartphone platform with Android. However, they are still miles behind Microsoft when it comes to providing a productive desktop-based OS (Chromium just doesn't cut it).

Enter Microsoft and their master plan of mobilizing its user base to a single, unified platform. This unification will translate to reduced efforts toward maintaining software compatibility across multiples operating systems while providing easier deployment of security fixes. For users, this means a more seamless multi-device experience. Imagine working on a presentation at home on your desktop, adding the finishing touches on your phone while on the way to the meeting, and using your Surface tablet to control the slide show. It is easy to foresee users purchasing Windows devices if they are promised such an integrated, hassle-free multi-device experience.

Are there any exceptions as to who can receive this upgrade for free?

Yes. The upgrade is only valid for Home and Pro editions of Windows 7/8/8.1 (OEM included). So entrepreneurs or business owners who plan to upgrade their organization's systems to the Windows 10 ecosystem will have to negotiate for a renewed Enterprise license deal. Similarly, home users running a copy of Windows XP or older will have to shell out full price for the upgrade. As it stands, Microsoft has no plans to offer any discounts to those using licensed copies of legacy versions.

How do I know if my PC qualifies?

First, there's the question of minimum system requirements. Fortunately, you are spared the need to upgrade your system's configuration if it was already capable of running Windows 7 and above as Windows 10 has the exact same requirements. On the other hand, if you plan on installing it on a system running Windows XP or older, do ensure your system meets the following requirements:

- ◆ 1 GHz (or faster) processor or SoC
- ◆ 1 GB RAM (for 32-bit) or 2 GB RAM (for 64-bit)
- ◆ Free hard drive space of 16 GB (for 32-bit) or 20 GB (for 64-bit OS)
- ◆ DirectX 9 (or later) graphics card with WDDM 1.0 driver
- ◆ Display with a resolution of 800x600 (or greater)